

Top 10 Open Source Tools for Web Developers



Wondering which open source tools to use for Web development? This article is a compilation of a list of IDEs (Integrated Development Environments), Web servers, databases, CMSs, etc, to help beginners looking for the best software.

Open source applications are the best tools, especially when it comes to Web development. Many of them have features comparable to expensive applications like Visual Studio, etc. If you cannot find all the features in one application, you could use a combination of two or more apps since you won't be spending money.

Writing an article that lists the best open source tools is not an easy task, as there are a lot to choose from and it's necessary that you try them out before selecting what works best for you. It also feels nice to share the experience. There are many tools that have made an impact, and will help you day after day. Some of you may disagree with my selection and may have your own favourites, but this list has been compiled on the basis of the ratings of a large number of users, and of course, my experience too.

1. Aptana Studio

When it comes to a free open source IDE for Web development for professionals in particular, I vote for Aptana Studio. At the time of writing this article, Aptana Studio 3.3.1 is available, with all the bugs that I encountered while using it on Windows a year ago, removed. But I guarantee that if you are a true open source fan and are crazy about Linux, you will find that it is best

on this platform. It is available for Mac OS X, Windows 7 and all Linux flavours as well as for 32-bit and 64-bit architectures. The core features behind its popularity are:

- Supports latest Web technologies like HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Ruby on Rails, PHP and Python, with information about the level of support for each element in major Web browsers.
- Syntax highlighting, auto-completion of code.



Figure 1: Aptana Studio